

product launch ever.

“Hello, I’m Macintosh. It sure is great to get out of that bag!

Unaccustomed as I am to public speaking, I’d like to share with you a maxim I thought of the first time I met an IBM mainframe. NEVER TRUST A COMPUTER YOU CAN’T LIFT!

Obviously, I can talk, but right now I’d like to sit back and listen. So, it is with considerable pride that I introduce a man who’s been like a father to me... STEVE JOBS.”

It had an intuitive graphical user interface and was the smallest and best-looking computer in the market at the time. “It was built around the new Motorola 68000 chip, which was significantly faster than previous processors, running at 8 MHz. The Mac came in a small beige case with a black and white monitor built in. It came with a keyboard and mouse, and had a floppy drive that took 400 KB 3.5” disks—the first personal computer to do so. It originally sold for \$2,495.” (Excerpt from *iCon: Steve Jobs—The Greatest Second Act in the History of Business*, by Jeffrey Young and William Simon.) Apple sold an outlandish number of Macintoshes in the first hundred days, a number close to 70,000 units.

1.3 The Fall

However, as with biggest first-generation products, the product had some severe flaws. The most major problem was the unavailability of software for the platform. The only company that was developing third-party software for the Mac was Microsoft. Apart from Microsoft Write, Paint, and Word, there was no other software you could install on your Mac. Compared to the thousands of software packages available for the IBM PC, the situation looked sad for Apple. The machine was not expandable, had a small black-and-white screen, too little RAM, and very little storage space. It was looked upon by consumers as a toy. Sales began falling drastically, and there was panic within the company. Apple was banking heavi-